



International Student Guide

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Dear Friends,

I am glad for the opportunity to welcome you to the website of our University!

Yerevan Haybusak University is an international multidisciplinary institution, accredited both nationally and by HAKA. As Armenia joined the Bologna process our University adopted the three-cycle education system (Bachelor, Master and Postgraduate) and began to uphold European standards, Haybusak annually welcomes about 4000 students from all over the world.

Throughout its activity, Haybusak University has gone a long way, improving, and increasing its capabilities every year, and hence the opportunities of our students. We assimilate and adapt the best of the principles of European education, while not forgetting the rich thousand-year-old traditions, passed on from the great minds of the past.

We are grateful to our brilliant teaching staff, which for already many years in a row has been opening the door to knowledge, professionalism, and mastery for our students from a multitude of countries, starting from Armenia, Russia, the CIS countries to Egypt, India, Iran and many more.

Our mission is to help young people acquire knowledge, skills and competencies that will help them become first-class specialists in their fields, and thus become demanded and successful people. The future of their countries will depend on them tomorrow. We want this future to be bright and beautiful in whatever sphere they work and whatever they do.

While having the infinite journey to knowledge before us, let us go through this experience together!

Should you have any further question, I will be delighted to answer all of them through the Feedback form.

Best wishes,

Suren Harutyunyan

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PART 1. YEREVAN HAYBUSAK UNIVERSITY

Introduction

Yerevan Haybusak University (YHU) was founded in 1990 due to the efforts of Levon Vram Harutyunyan, honorable scientist and academician. Since its establishment the University has been managed by three rectors, namely, Academician Levon Vram Harutyunyan (1991-1992), Doctor of Philology and Professor Anahit Levon Harutyunyan (1992-2015) and Suren Levon Harutyunyan (since 2015).

In 2001 the University was awarded with state certificate which enables YHU graduates to get state diploma and work in Armenia and abroad as well as to continue their postgraduate education in Armenian or foreign institutions. In 2023 the YHU renewed its accreditation by Estonian agency HAKA.

Vision and mission

Our vision is thousands of talented, knowledgeable, and caring professionals and scientists educated in a free academic space who consistently improve the well-being of people and communities and care for the environment. Our mission is to be a new type of university that empowers all participants for self-realisation as versatile specialists, creative thinkers and improvers of the life of their communities, combining the best qualities of private and public education systems.

Institutes and Study Programs

The Yerevan Haybusak University consists of four institutes with following specialties:

- 1) Medicine. medical@haybusak.am. Dean office: first floor of the Abelyan campus. Includes Haybusak clinic, Dental clinic and Simulation centre.
 - General Medicine (MD)
 - Dentistry (DMD)
 - Pharmacology (BA, MA)
 - Environmental Protection and Natural Use (BA)
- 2) Law & International Relations. law@haybusak.am. Dean office: Griboyedov campus. Includes Legal clinic and Criminalistics laboratory.
 - Jurisprudence (BA, MA)
 - International Relations (BA, MA)
- 3) Economics & Management. economics@haybusak.am. Dean office: Griboyedov campus.
 - Management (BA, MA)
 - Economics (BA, MA)
 - Finances (BA, MA)

- Informatics (BA, MA)

4) Arts & Humanities. humanities@haybusak.am. Dean office: Griboyedov campus. Includes Psychological aid clinic and Design Laboratory.

- Fashion Design and Modeling (BA, MA)
- Fine Art (BA, MA)
- Psychology (BA, MA)
- Professional Pedagogy (English language and literature)(BA, MA)
- General Pedagogy (Armenian language and literature)(BA, MA)
- Journalism (BA, MA)
- Pedagogy and Psychology (BA, MA)

132 proficient specialists teach at YHU and about 62% of them have scientific degree and title. Currently over 2000 students from Armenia and abroad study at YHU. The University has a base college which implements middle-level vocational study programs. Since 2010 the base college is an associated member of the UNESCO vocational educational institutions. Since 2007 there is a high school in YHU. Since 2006 the YHU has a Shirakatsi branch in Gyumri.

International relations

In the last decade, the YHU has progressively become international, with Armenia's highest share of international students (53%), international conferences, and expanding cross-border ties. Today Haybusak is home to students and teachers from various cultural backgrounds. Students from more than 30 countries have graduated from YHU, and that trend has progressively increased over the past decade. YHU has 11 study programmes in English.

The YHU joined the European Universities Association in 2022.

For all questions regarding Erasmus+ projects, student exchange, international visits, cooperation with other universities students may contact the International Relations Office international@haybusak.am. Third floor of the Abelyan campus.

PART 2. PREPARING TO STUDY AT YHU

Admission

Applicant can apply for enrollment through haybusak.am/applicant-transfer.

Entry and residence

International students arriving to Armenia must have valid passport, entry visa or a residency permit. The student should apply for e-visa evisa.mfa.am or a single entry visitor visa to the nearest Armenian embassy by submitting the following documents:

- 1) visa application mfa.am/filemanager/consular/visa/2022/01-ARM-VISA-APPLICATION-2022.pdf
- 2) color photo 35x45 mm
- 3) passport and its copy (valid during the whole period of stay in Armenia)
- 4) invitation from the university received after admission
- 5) payment of the state duty.

After arriving to Armenia, he/she should obtain a temporary resident card by submitting the following documents to the Passport and Visa Department of the Ministry of Internal Affairs (17/10, 4th District, Davtashen, Yerevan):

- 1) application form avv.police.am/images/kacutyun.pdf
- 2) 3 color photos 35x45 mm
- 3) passport, its copy and notarized translation into Armenian
- 4) proof of enrollment in the university
- 5) health certificate.

The appointment is booked online at migration.e-gov.am/en. Processing time is 30 days.

Housing

The YHU does not have a dormitory. Students can rent rooms, shared or private apartments in the city from owners.

Healthcare

There is a clinic with modern medical equipment on the first floor of the YHU. The following medical services are provided to the YHU students:

- medical examination and check-up of students with poor health in the student clinic,
- fulfillment of sanitary-hygienic works once every week,
- general check-up of students under dynamic medical control once per month,

- medical examination of students, detection of diseases twice per year and referral to student clinic upon necessity.

No particularly dangerous infections have been registered on the territory of Armenia.

Wide-profile medical services are provided mainly within the city of Yerevan. Medical services to foreigners are provided on a paid basis. Therefore, it is recommended to purchase an insurance policy valid in Armenia. Most of the Armenian insurance companies offer various life and health insurance programs.

Specific vaccination is not required before leaving for Armenia. Urgent medical care: Republican Medical Center “Armenia”, tel. +374-10-31-82-46 (24 hours), Erebuni Medical Center, tel. +374-10-47-11-06 (24 hours), Nairi Medical Center, tel. +374-10-53-75-00 (24 hours). Urgent veterinary care: Koryun st., 15, tel. 52-59-56. “Aragil” (Amiryan st., 10; tel. +374-10-56-01-19).

PART 3. STUDING AT YHU

Academics

The University encourages activeness, initiatives, innovation and provides all the opportunities for high quality learning and self-expression. This can be clearly stated by the reward of quality which was awarded to the University by the SIQS in 2016.

The academic year comprises two semesters: September-December and February-May. In 2008 the University has made the transition to the three-level system which suggests Bachelor, Master and Doctorate programs with the duration of four (30 hours per week), one/two (18 hours per week) and three years (4 hours per week) respectively.

In YHU the classes are conducted based on the set regulation, in accordance with curricula, study programs and class schedules. The class schedule is formed for one semester and it is posted not later than 5 working days prior to the start of the semester. The class schedule is as follows: 09:00-10:20, 10:30-11:50, 12:10-13:30, 13:40-15:00, 15:10-16:30. Courses last 16 weeks and contain lectures, seminars, individual work, laboratory work, internships, consultancies. Assessment includes course and final papers, mid-term and final check.

YHU participates in the European Credit Transfer System (ECTS) of the Bologna process which allows students to easily transfer from one HEI to another, from one country to another one during their studies, and in case of change of the specialty the credits of all courses which deal with the new specialty are taken into consideration. ECTS credits from foreign universities for a specific time of study are recognized by the YHU. The two main characteristics of the ECTS are as follows: a) the credit can be transferred, b) the credit can be accumulated.

Credit is the time which has been allocated to the given subject in class, for practical courses, lab activities, educational-industrial internship, library, independent and extracurricular activities as well as for preparation and taking of exams. 30 hours are equal to 1 credit and. During one academic semester the student accumulates about 30 credits, and in one academic year – 60 credits. In order to have Bachelor's degree, it is necessary to accumulate 180-240 credits, and in case of Master's degree – 60-120 credits. In order to accumulate credits, the student should be provided information on the number of credits required for the given subject. The credit is allocated to the student as a result of his/her grading, and only in case of a positive grade the student gets the credit.

You can get information about each specialty, list of defined mandatory and elective subject courses and respective number of credits as well as conditions and regulation on successful completion of courses in the respective Dean's Office, from the teacher of each subject and from the website of the University.

Besides credits, the student also gets grades which indicates his/her academic performance. The credit reflects the amount of activity carried out by the student, and the grade - the quality of the activity. The YHU uses 100-point grade scale for knowledge check, where 40 points is required to pass exam.

Disputes regarding evaluation and technical violations of the examination procedure are resolved by the rectorate. The student has the right to appeal the examination assessment within 5 days after being informed about it.

The student card is a document which verifies the status of the YHU student. In case the student has lost or damaged his/her student card, he/she has to immediately inform about it to the Dean's Office to get a new document.

At the beginning of study of each student a check book is provided. The check book contains information about full- or part-time study, level of education, faculty, courses, credits, internship and final attestation. In case of transfer to another university or dismissal from YHU the student has to return the check book and instead is provided with an academic reference.

Students with high performance, active participation in research or public works are rewarded with a certificate of honor and a monetary bonus.

Sports

The University has a gym with sports facilities which the students can use both in and outside their classes of physical training. There are volleyball, basketball, table tennis, light athletics training groups which are organized due to the efforts of coach-teachers. The YHU representatives have participated in a number of national and international competitions (student games, Pan-Armenian games, etc.) and have registered many achievements. The University organizes internal competitions in different types of sport. Second floor of the Abelyan campus.

Library

Students and staff of the University has the right to use the library. Outsiders can use the library only with special permission of the Head of the library. Currently the YHU library has more than 40 000 units of literature and it is continuously being enriched.

The library has a reading hall and an e-library resources available at haybusaklib.am. Students can also use the online learning platform haybusakmoodle.am.

University has access to collections of the JSTOR (jstor.org) and Cambridge University Press (cambridge.org/core) digital libraries which give students the possibility to use multilingual and multisubject books and journals through the library's computers or wifi "haybusak guest".

The library is located on the. The working hours are 09:00-17:00, and the break time is 13:00-14:00. The use of library is free of charge.

In order to become a library user, it is necessary register by submitting the student card and a photo. The registered library users can borrow up to 4 books for up to 15 days. The unique literature, books having one copy, encyclopedias, unpublished materials as well as PhD dissertations and MA theses are available only in the reading hall. In case the user has lost the book or has damaged it, he/she is obliged either to substitute it or to compensate library@haybusak.am. Second floor of the Abelyan campus.

Student Council

is a students' representative, self-governing elective body. It is apolitical and non-partisan. During his activity, the council constantly monitors the improvement of the quality of students' education, to the formation of a student-centered system, correct student-teacher relations in the university development, formation of a favorable atmosphere for education. The cultural and sports life of the university is largely determined by the Student Council by activity. It organizes excursions, hikes, introducing them to natural and historical monuments, helps foreign students to correctly orient themselves to Armenian culture.

The focus of the Student Council's attention is on environmental issues, the coverage of which is permanent in the university. In recent years, the Student Council has been paying a lot of attention to student volunteering movement, promotes the involvement of University students in various volunteer groups.

Students also have a possibility to become members of the University Council and Scientific Council, the governing bodies of the institution.

Alumni and Career Support Centre

The Career Center has been operating at YHU in order to increase the competitiveness of students and graduates in the labor market, develop the professional practical abilities of students during their studies, strengthen the permanent connection between graduates and the university, and study the needs of employers. The main goal of the Center is to collect information about the future careers of graduates and to facilitate access to information about job vacancies, strengthening the permanent connection between the University and graduates. narinehovsepyankariera@gmail.com

PART 4. ARMENIA AND YEREVAN

Safety Issues

The likelihood of terrorist incidents is low. The crime situation in the country does not cause concern. The situation is confidently controlled by local law enforcement agencies.

Transport and driving

You may use taxi by stopping in the street or using applications (Uber, Yandex). Metro and buses are available as a city public transport.

The Kilikia bus station is located on Admiral Isakov Avenue, Northern bus station – on Sevan Highway. The railway station is located on Tigran Mets Ave., a 10-minute drive from the city center. Zvartnots International Airport is a 20-minute drive from the center of the capital.

Traffic rules mostly correspond to international. Due to the increase in the number of vehicles, the roads in Yerevan are congested during rush hours, but there are no massive traffic jams. Traffic on highways in other settlements is not very intense. Gas stations are located everywhere, both in cities and on highways. A significant part of the vehicle fleet in Armenia (including personal vehicles) has been converted to use gas. Parking on city streets is free, except in the center of Yerevan, near large stores.

It is possible to use an international driver's license. There is compulsory civil liability insurance for vehicle owners. In the event of an accident, you must call the traffic police and representatives of the insurance company, if the car is insured. Trying to resolve the situation on the spot is not recommended.

Local laws and customs

The attitude towards visitors in Armenia is the most friendly and hospitable. At the same time, traditional norms of behavior are adhered to. It is customary to show respect for elders and attention to children. Excessive consumption of alcoholic beverages and cheeky behavior in public places are not encouraged.

Foreign citizens and legal entities are not entitled to land ownership. The exception is for foreign citizens who have a special residence permit holders in the Republic of Armenia. Residence permits and citizenship are not granted for real estate or investments.

Working While Studying

Students in Armenia are allowed to work 20 hours per week alongside their studies. You can get a part time job within campus or outside. However, you may need prior permission

from study department to work while studying. Also you can do extra work during weekends and holidays.

Useful phone numbers

Ministry of Emergencies – 911, 101, 102;

Emergency medical care – 103;

Gas network hotline – 104;

Traffic police hotline – 177;

Electric network hotline – 180;

Business reference "Spyur" – 113;

Airport information desks: "Zvartnots" – 187.

Other

Armenia has a temperate, high-mountain continental climate with hot summers and cold winters. On the plains, the average temperature in January is -5°C , in July – about $+25^{\circ}\text{C}$; in the mountains these figures are -6°C and $+20^{\circ}\text{C}$, respectively. The annual precipitation in the Ararat Valley is from 200 to 250 mm, and in the highlands - from 700 to 900 mm.

Time zone is UTC+4. No summer time change.

Holidays: January 1-2 – New Year, January 6-7 – Christmas, January 28 – Army Day, March 8 – Women's Day, April 24 – Genocide Remembrance Day, May 1 – Labor Day, May 9 – Victory and Peace Day, May 28 – Republic Day, July 5 – Constitution Day, September 21 – Independence Day.

Monthly living expenses for international students in Armenia start from 250 000 drams, including accommodation.

Local banks provide wide range of financial services and online banking. International students may open accounts in main currencies by submitting ID, proof of residence and other documents requested by the bank, and wait for 1-2 weeks.

Shops are open from 8.00 to 20.00 without a lunch break. Large supermarkets are open 24 hours a day. Most ATMs, stores, restaurants accept Visa and MasterCard credit cards. Practice of applying for duty-free is available in the capital only in some stores. Mobile communications are represented by three GSM operators: Armentel (Beeline), Vivacell (MTS), U-com, Team.

For information about recreation and entertainment refer to visityerevan.am.